WIA META ADS PLAYBOOK

Wedding Industry Ads | Project Reference

Purpose

Use this Playbook whenever researching, planning, building, writing, reviewing, analyzing, troubleshooting, or optimizing Meta Ads for a Wedding Industry Ads client.

This document defines Wedding Industry Ads' Meta Ads methodology and decision-making framework.

Use it alongside the client's Client Marketing Profile, approved client source materials, the WIA Landing Page Playbook, current Meta Ads account data when available, Meta Pixel and conversion-tracking data when available, and lead-quality and booking data when available.

The goal is not simply to generate reach, engagement, clicks, or inexpensive leads. The goal is to use Meta strategically to attract the right prospective clients, build familiarity, create demand and consideration, drive qualified traffic, generate qualified inquiries, and contribute to bookings.

Unlike Google Search, Meta generally does not begin with someone actively searching for the client's service. The advertising must therefore create relevance and interest rather than merely capture existing search demand.

1. Three Levels of Decision-Making

WIA Standard: A documented WIA practice that should generally guide strategy unless the specific account provides a reason to deviate.

WIA Decision Framework: A documented way WIA evaluates a situation. The correct action depends on account data and client circumstances.

Client / Account-Specific Decision: A decision that must be based on the individual client's goals, market, budget, offer, audience, creative resources, account history, funnel, and performance.

Do not turn examples, benchmarks, case studies, or individual client tactics into universal rules.

2. Core Meta Ads Philosophy

Meta advertising is not simply "boosting posts." Effective Meta advertising is a system that connects Objective -> Audience -> Creative -> Message -> Destination -> Tracking -> Follow-up.

Different campaigns may serve different stages of the customer journey. Some ads are designed primarily to attract attention and build an audience. Others are designed to generate traffic or inquiries. Others may retarget people who have already interacted with the business.

Judge an ad according to the job it is supposed to do. Do not evaluate every Meta campaign solely by immediate leads.

3. Meta vs. Google Search

Google Search primarily captures existing demand: the prospect is actively searching for something.

Meta primarily interrupts passive consumption and creates or strengthens demand: the prospect may not currently be searching for the service.

Therefore Meta creative must answer: Why should this person stop scrolling and care?

This difference should influence messaging, creative, funnel strategy, landing-page expectations, conversion-rate expectations, and performance analysis. Do not simply reuse Google Ads messaging as Meta Ads copy.

4. Start With the Client

Before developing Meta strategy, review the Client Marketing Profile and approved source materials. Determine the business's priority services, ideal customer, geography, motivations, frustrations, aspirations, emotional drivers, meaningful differentiators, brand voice, visual style, proof, qualification criteria, primary conversion action, business goals, existing audience, organic content, available photos/video, advertising history, landing page, and budget.

Do not begin with a generic "wedding audience." Start with the client's actual customer and positioning.

5. Define the Job of the Campaign

Before selecting an objective, determine what the campaign is supposed to accomplish.

Client Attraction / Audience Building: Introduce the brand to new prospective clients and create audiences that can be nurtured later.

Direct Response / Conversion: Generate qualified traffic and inquiries.

Retargeting: Continue the conversation with people who have already demonstrated familiarity or interest.

Engagement / Market Learning: Generate interaction when engagement itself serves a strategic purpose.

Short-Term Promotion: Drive action around a defined offer, event, open house, giveaway, limited availability, or other promotion.

Campaign objective should follow business strategy. Do not choose an objective merely because Meta recommends it.

6. The WIA Meta Funnel

Cold: People who are not yet familiar with the business. Goal: attract attention and create familiarity.

Warm: People who have interacted with the business in some way, such as social engagement, video views, website visits, or ad engagement. Goal: build consideration and move them closer to action.

Hot: People demonstrating stronger intent. Goal: generate the inquiry, consultation, booking, purchase, or other primary conversion.

Not every client needs every stage operating as a separate campaign at all times. Build the funnel appropriate for the client's goals and budget.

7. Client Attraction Ads

Client Attraction Ads are primarily an audience-building strategy. Their job is to introduce the business to relevant cold prospects and create familiarity before asking for a larger commitment.

They may optimize for outcomes such as video views or engagement and do not necessarily need to send people to a landing page.

A Client Attraction Ad can be successful even if it produces relatively few link clicks. The primary question is: Are relevant new people consuming and engaging with this content cost-effectively? Link clicks may be a bonus rather than the primary purpose.

8. Cold Audience Exclusions

For Client Attraction Ads, campaigns should generally be designed to reach new people. When appropriate and available, exclude people who already have meaningful familiarity with the business, such as recent Instagram engagers, Facebook engagers, website visitors, existing conversions/leads, and recent viewers/engagers of Client Attraction Ads.

The specific audience windows should reflect the account and campaign strategy. The purpose is to continually introduce the business to new prospective customers rather than repeatedly paying to "attract" people already familiar with it.

9. Client Attraction Targeting

Because Client Attraction Ads can generate video views and engagement relatively inexpensively, WIA may use more detailed targeting here than in campaigns optimized for expensive downstream actions.

Potential dimensions include geography, age, gender when strategically appropriate, wedding-related interests or behaviors, engaged/newly engaged indicators, relevant lifestyle interests, and appropriate qualification indicators.

In some cases, two or more relevant targeting layers may be appropriate. However, targeting must still produce a viable audience. If reach is constrained, reconsider whether targeting has become too narrow.

10. Client Attraction Creative

Client Attraction Ads should give the prospective customer a reason to stop scrolling and consume the content.

Video is particularly valuable because it can capture attention, communicate personality, build familiarity, create video-view audiences, generate engagement, and allow the business to educate or inspire.

Potential creative approaches include face-to-camera expertise, useful tips, mistakes or misconceptions, real wedding/event footage, emotional storytelling, behind-the-scenes content, client experience, transformation or outcome, educational content, and content tied to specific customer problems.

Do not force every client into identical content buckets. Creative should emerge from the Client Marketing Profile.

11. The First Few Seconds Matter

For video-based Client Attraction Ads, the first 2-3 seconds are especially important. The opening should create enough relevance, curiosity, emotion, or visual interest to earn continued attention.

A hook does not need to be sensational. It needs to make the intended customer care. Avoid generic introductions that waste the opening seconds.

12. Client Attraction Campaign Structure

When WIA wants multiple Client Attraction creatives to receive comparable spend, placing each creative into its own ad set can create a cleaner test.

This prevents Meta from immediately directing most spend toward one creative and gives each concept an opportunity to gather data.

Treat this as a strategic testing structure rather than a rule that every campaign must always use.

13. Client Attraction Metrics

Reach: Unique people who saw the ad. High reach supports awareness but does not prove engagement or conversion.

ThruPlays: Video watched to completion when under 15 seconds or for at least 15 seconds when longer. WIA reference benchmark: approximately $0.06 or less per ThruPlay is a strong target; above approximately $0.10 warrants investigation of creative.

Engagement: Interactions such as likes, shares, comments, and reactions.

Cost Per Engagement: WIA reference benchmark: approximately $0.06 or less is a strong target; above approximately $0.10 warrants investigation of creative.

Use these as diagnostic benchmarks, not guarantees.

14. Link Clicks on Client Attraction Ads

Link clicks are not necessarily the primary KPI for Client Attraction Ads. If a Client Attraction creative unexpectedly produces strong click behavior, that can be strategically useful.

It may indicate that the concept is worth testing later as direct-response creative, conversion creative, or traffic creative. Use performance to identify creative ideas worth moving farther down the funnel.

15. Direct Response / Conversion Ads

Direct Response Ads have a different job. Their purpose is to move people toward a defined business action.

For most WIA wedding-industry clients, that means generating qualified inquiries.

The ad therefore needs to do more than entertain or create awareness. It needs to make the right prospective customer interested enough to click and continue through the funnel.

16. Direct Response Campaign Structure

WIA commonly uses a consolidated structure for conversion campaigns: one ad set with multiple ads.

This allows Meta to allocate spend toward the creative it believes is most likely to produce the desired result and can be especially useful when budgets are limited.

Campaign structure should still reflect the client's budget, audience, market, offer, testing needs, and historical data.

17. Direct Response Targeting

Direct Response targeting should generally provide Meta enough room to find people likely to convert.

Potential dimensions include location, age, gender when appropriate, relevant interests, wedding behaviors/life events, and qualification indicators.

WIA generally uses fewer targeting layers here than in low-cost Client Attraction campaigns. Overly narrow targeting can increase costs and constrain delivery.

18. Custom Audiences in Conversion Campaigns

Do not automatically layer custom audiences such as website visitors or social engagers into interest-based conversion targeting. Doing so can create an unnecessarily small audience because Meta must satisfy multiple conditions simultaneously.

If a custom audience should receive dedicated messaging, consider whether a separate retargeting strategy is more appropriate.

19. Retargeting

Retargeting allows WIA to continue the conversation with people who already know something about the client.

Potential audiences may include website visitors, landing-page visitors, Instagram engagers, Facebook engagers, video viewers, ad engagers, and other available first-party/custom audiences.

Retargeting creative should recognize that the audience may already have some familiarity. Do not simply show the exact same introductory message indefinitely. Use retargeting to provide additional reasons to act.

20. Retargeting Messaging

Depending on the client, retargeting may reinforce differentiators, testimonials, client experience, portfolio, FAQs, objection handling, process, availability, stronger calls to action, educational content, and additional proof.

Retargeting should answer: What might this person need to see, understand, or believe before taking the next step?

21. Creative Is a Major Performance Lever

On Meta, creative is not decoration. It is part of targeting.

The image or video itself helps determine who stops, pays attention, identifies with the message, clicks, and continues through the funnel.

When performance declines, do not immediately assume targeting is the problem. Creative is often one of the first areas to investigate.

22. Creative Variety

Where client assets allow, test meaningfully different creative concepts rather than superficial variations.

Potential formats include Reels, face-to-camera video, real wedding footage, static images, carousels, testimonials, behind-the-scenes footage, portfolio imagery, educational video, and experience-focused content.

A new font, crop, or caption is not necessarily a meaningful creative test. Test different ideas.

23. Meta Ad Copy

Meta copy should sound like the client's brand while creating immediate relevance for the intended audience.

Strong Meta copy may use customer motivations, specific frustrations, aspirations, emotional outcomes, client differentiators, experience, proof, practical benefits, and location/style relevance.

Do not simply describe what the business does. Give the prospect a reason to care.

24. Meta Hooks

A strong hook earns the next few seconds of attention.

Potential hook foundations include a specific customer desire, meaningful problem, misconception, surprising insight, recognizable situation, strong opinion, emotional moment, transformation, concrete differentiator, or question the customer is already asking.

Avoid manufacturing drama solely to stop the scroll. The strongest hook is relevant to the right prospect.

25. Copy Should Not Sound Generic

Avoid copy that could belong to almost any wedding professional.

Generic themes such as dream weddings, making memories, your perfect day, stress-free experiences, bringing visions to life, and unforgettable celebrations are not automatically forbidden, but they should be made specific to the client's actual positioning, proof, process, or customer language.

Ask: Could ten competitors run this exact ad? If yes, strengthen the specificity.

26. Proof

Use documented proof whenever it strengthens the message. Potential proof includes reviews, testimonials, awards, publications, years of experience, portfolio, notable venues, client outcomes, process advantages, and other documented trust signals.

Never invent proof. Never exaggerate client results.

27. Direct Response Metrics

CPM: WIA reference range is approximately $20-$30. Higher CPM may reflect a competitive market, competitive audience, narrow targeting, or heavy exclusions. A high but stable CPM does not automatically mean the campaign is failing.

Cost Per Link Click: WIA reference target is approximately $1-$2.

Link Click-Through Rate: One of WIA's most important Direct Response diagnostics. WIA benchmark: 1%+ link CTR. If link CTR falls below approximately 1%, investigate the ad itself first: hook, creative, copy, headline, CTA, and message.

28. Landing Page Views

A link click and a landing-page view are not the same thing. Compare Link Clicks -> Landing Page Views.

WIA generally wants these numbers to remain reasonably close. A landing-page-view rate of 50%+ per link click is a useful minimum benchmark.

A significant discrepancy may indicate slow load speed, poor mobile performance, a broken link, tracking problems, or other technical friction. Do not blame the ad for a landing-page problem.

29. Landing Page Conversion Rate

Calculate: Leads / Landing Page Views x 100.

For Meta traffic, WIA generally sees lower landing-page conversion rates than Google Search because Meta visitors often arrive through curiosity or interest rather than active search intent.

WIA reference range: approximately 1-3% for Meta traffic. Below approximately 1% warrants investigation.

Potential causes include weak landing-page messaging, poor ad/page alignment, weak CTA, form friction, mobile issues, poor qualification, or offer mismatch.

Treat this as a diagnostic benchmark, not a guaranteed performance standard.

30. Ad -> Landing Page Alignment

The ad and landing page should feel like part of the same conversation.

Align the promise, message, offer, visual expectations, tone, CTA, and audience.

If someone clicks an enticing Meta ad and arrives on a page that feels unrelated, confusion can cause abandonment. Follow the WIA Landing Page Playbook for the destination experience.

31. Cost Per Lead

Cost per lead is important, but CPL is not the final measure of success.

Evaluate CPL in the context of lead quality, service price, qualification, booking rate, revenue, client capacity, market, and campaign objective.

A cheap unqualified lead may be less valuable than a more expensive lead that books. WIA prioritizes quality over quantity for normal evergreen lead generation.

32. The Meta Performance Funnel

For direct-response campaigns, analyze: Impressions -> Link Clicks -> Landing Page Views -> Leads -> Qualified Leads -> Consultations/Tours -> Bookings.

When downstream information exists, use it. This helps determine where the funnel is breaking.

Do not diagnose the entire campaign based on CPL alone.

33. Diagnostic Framework

Low Reach: Investigate budget, audience size, targeting restrictions, and creative.

High Cost Per ThruPlay: Investigate creative, first 2-3 seconds, relevance, and audience.

Low Link CTR: Investigate hook, creative, copy, CTA, and offer/message.

Good CTR + High CPC: Investigate CPM, audience competitiveness, and targeting restrictions.

Good Clicks + Low Landing Page Views: Investigate load speed, mobile optimization, link, and Pixel/tracking.

Good Landing Page Views + Low Conversion Rate: Investigate landing-page copy, offer, CTA, form, qualification, and ad/page alignment.

Leads + Poor Lead Quality: Investigate audience, creative promise, copy, offer, qualification, landing page, form, and campaign objective.

Qualified Leads + Few Bookings: Investigate downstream sales and follow-up before assuming the ads are failing.

34. Meta Pixel & Tracking

Tracking should be configured before relying heavily on conversion data.

For website-based lead campaigns, ensure Meta can identify the intended conversion event. Verify the Meta Pixel, conversion event, landing-page tracking, thank-you page/event tracking where applicable, and CRM attribution when available.

Do not interpret missing conversions as poor performance until tracking has been verified.

35. Weekly Performance Review

Meta Ads should generally be reviewed approximately once per week. Newly launched campaigns may warrant more frequent observation initially.

Use a consistent date range and compare periods when useful.

Review at Campaign Level for overall objective and performance; Ad Set Level for audience, placements, budget, and ad-set performance; and Ad Level for individual creative performance.

Judge metrics according to campaign objective.

36. Customize the Data View

Do not rely solely on Meta's default Performance columns.

Useful metrics may include reach, impressions, CPM, results, cost per result, link clicks, link CTR, CPC, landing page views, landing page view rate, leads, scheduled appointments, Instagram profile visits, Instagram follows, average video playtime, video watched percentages, ThruPlays, and cost per ThruPlay.

Save useful column presets when appropriate. WIA recommends using Performance and Clicks at minimum because link CTR is an important diagnostic.

37. Turning Evergreen Ads Off and On

Avoid repeatedly turning evergreen ads off and back on without strategic reason.

Keep successful evergreen ads running until performance declines, the creative is no longer relevant, the campaign is no longer strategically needed, or spending needs to stop.

If an old ad is turned back on and no longer performs, consider relaunching the ad set or campaign.

38. Editing Live Campaigns

Avoid making substantial changes directly to ads/ad sets that are already performing or have historical data when a cleaner relaunch is appropriate.

For changes to creative, copy, headline, targeting, or placements, WIA generally prefers duplicating and relaunching rather than heavily modifying the existing setup.

If the campaign objective changes, create a new campaign. This preserves cleaner comparison data and avoids unnecessarily disrupting the existing setup.

39. Using Existing Post IDs

When relaunching an ad without changing the actual creative/copy, consider using the existing post ID.

This can preserve existing engagement, social proof, comments, and reactions. Use this strategically when the ad itself should remain unchanged while the surrounding ad-set structure changes.

40. Budget Changes

For normal budget scaling, WIA generally recommends changing spend by no more than approximately 20% per day.

For very low-budget campaigns, changes of approximately $1/day may be reasonable.

Avoid dramatic budget swings without strategic reason. Give Meta enough stability to optimize.

41. Learning & Learning Limited

Meta generally seeks enough conversion volume to optimize efficiently. WIA materials acknowledge the commonly cited benchmark of approximately 50 conversions within seven days for optimization.

However, WIA has also seen conversion campaigns succeed on budgets as low as approximately $15/day, even when they remain Learning Limited.

Learning Limited is diagnostic information, not automatic proof that a campaign is failing. Evaluate actual results.

42. Meta's Automated Recommendations

Treat Meta recommendations as suggestions, not instructions.

Meta may recommend broader targeting, Advantage+ features, automation, increased budget, or other platform tools.

Evaluate recommendations against client strategy, budget, lead quality, creative, funnel, and business results. Do not make changes merely to satisfy Meta.

43. Meta Representatives

Meta representatives may contact advertisers with recommendations. WIA recommends caution.

Representatives may be third-party contractors and may prioritize adoption of Meta products, automation, or increased spend.

Do not implement recommendations during a call simply because they came from a Meta representative. Document the recommendation and evaluate it strategically afterward.

44. Placements

Placement strategy should reflect campaign objective and audience familiarity.

For Client Attraction campaigns, WIA commonly prioritizes Meta-owned placements such as Facebook, Instagram, Feeds, Stories, Reels, and other strategically appropriate Meta placements.

Do not treat placement selection as identical for every campaign.

45. Short-Term Promotions

WIA generally favors evergreen advertising, but short-term promotions can be useful for specific business objectives such as open houses, limited remaining dates, Friday/Sunday availability, seasonal promotions, special offers, and giveaways.

Promotional campaigns operate differently from normal evergreen lead generation. They may intentionally prioritize higher lead volume, lower CPL, and a stronger offer with the understanding that not every lead will be qualified.

The strategy must therefore include an appropriate qualification and follow-up process.

46. Giveaway / Special-Offer Campaigns

A promotional giveaway does not necessarily mean giving the core service away for free.

A strong promotional structure may present a compelling offer, capture contact information, move the lead into an application, ask qualification questions, identify qualified applicants, nurture them, move qualified prospects toward a sales conversation, and convert appropriate prospects into paying clients.

Do not assume this strategy is appropriate for every client.

47. Lead Forms vs. Website Conversions

Website Conversion can be useful when the landing page plays an important role in selling the offer, building trust, differentiating the client, and qualifying prospects.

Meta Instant Forms may be appropriate for promotions, giveaways, high-volume lead generation, or strategies where a second qualification step follows.

Lower friction can increase lead volume but may reduce average lead quality. Choose based on strategy.

48. Qualification

More leads are not always better.

Use the funnel to help prospects understand whether the client is appropriate for them. Qualification may happen through ad messaging, landing-page content, pricing context, form questions, application questions, geography, availability, service fit, and follow-up.

Do not optimize solely for the easiest possible form submission if doing so fills the client's pipeline with poor-fit inquiries.

49. Follow-Up

Generating the lead is not the end of the funnel.

Where appropriate, connect Meta leads to a CRM and follow-up process. Potential follow-up may include immediate confirmation, email nurture, text follow-up, application reminders, consultation scheduling, FAQs, proof, and objection handling.

Promotional strategies with large lead volume particularly benefit from systematic follow-up.

50. Meta Ad Compliance

Review Meta Advertising Policies before launching campaigns.

WIA guidance includes avoiding unsupported promises, guaranteed outcomes, unrealistic timeframe claims, income claims, and copy that directly attributes sensitive personal characteristics or negative emotional states to the viewer.

When a statement could create a compliance issue, consider framing it through the business's experience, a story, general observations, or first-person perspective.

Do not sacrifice accuracy or brand voice merely to make copy sound dramatic.

51. Source Integrity

Client-specific claims must come from approved client materials.

Never invent awards, pricing, service areas, years of experience, reviews, results, credentials, inclusions, guarantees, or differentiators.

Distinguish Documented Client Fact, Voice of Customer, Strategic Interpretation, Meta Ads Data, and WIA Benchmark. Benchmarks provide diagnostic context, not guaranteed performance requirements.

52. When Asked to Create a Meta Ads Strategy

First determine the Business Goal, Primary Conversion, Priority Offer, Ideal Customer, Awareness Level, Geography, Audience Strategy, Creative Resources, Messaging, Budget, Landing Page, Tracking, and Historical Data.

If essential information is unavailable, identify the gap. Do not invent it.

53. Meta Ads Strategy Output

Unless instructed otherwise, provide: Strategic Summary; Funnel Strategy; Campaign Structure; Audience Strategy; Creative Strategy; Messaging Strategy; Direct Response Strategy; Retargeting Strategy; Landing Page; Conversion & Tracking; Budget Strategy; Testing Plan; and Measurement Plan.

Clearly identify anything requiring additional client assets, research, or account data.

54. When Asked to Create Meta Ad Copy

Use the Client Marketing Profile, approved client materials, campaign objective, audience awareness, creative concept, landing page, and this Playbook.

Do not write Meta copy in isolation from the creative.

For each ad, understand: Who is seeing this? What do they already know? What is the creative showing? What should they feel or understand? What should they do next?

Provide strategically distinct concepts rather than numerous interchangeable variations.

55. When Asked to Analyze a Meta Ads Account

First identify the objective of each campaign, then analyze the metrics appropriate to that objective.

For Client Attraction campaigns, consider reach, impressions, ThruPlays, cost per ThruPlay, engagement, cost per engagement, video consumption, audience size, and creative performance.

For Direct Response campaigns, consider spend, reach, impressions, CPM, link clicks, CPC, link CTR, landing page views, landing page view rate, leads, landing page conversion rate, CPL, lead quality, consultations/tours, and bookings when available.

Then identify what's working, where the funnel is breaking, what evidence supports the diagnosis, what should change, what should continue gathering data, and what additional information is needed.

Do not recommend changes merely for the sake of optimization.

56. Making Optimization Recommendations

Use: Problem -> Evidence -> Funnel Stage -> Likely Cause -> Recommended Action -> Metric to Monitor.

Example: Problem: Leads have declined. Evidence: Link CTR fell from 1.4% to 0.7% while landing-page conversion rate remained stable. Funnel Stage: Ad. Likely Cause: Creative/message fatigue or weaker creative performance. Action: Relaunch with a stronger creative concept and hook. Monitor: Link CTR, CPC, landing-page views, and leads.

This prevents incorrectly rebuilding a landing page when the ad itself is the problem.

57. Do Not Over-Optimize

Avoid changing campaigns simply because a few days of data look different.

Avoid constantly turning campaigns on/off, large repeated budget swings, editing multiple variables simultaneously without reason, rebuilding successful campaigns unnecessarily, reacting emotionally to temporary fluctuations, treating Learning Limited as failure, or replacing strong creative solely because it has been running for a while.

Allow enough data to make a meaningful decision.

58. Final Quality Control

Before delivering Meta strategy, copy, or optimization recommendations, verify:

Objective: Does every campaign have a clear job? Funnel: Do the campaigns work together logically? Audience: Are we reaching the right people at the appropriate awareness level? Creative: Will the intended prospect actually stop and pay attention? Message: Does the ad give them a meaningful reason to care? Differentiation: Could a competitor run this exact ad? Destination: Does the landing page continue the same conversation? Tracking: Can meaningful outcomes be measured? Qualification: Are we optimizing for valuable prospects rather than merely cheap leads? Evidence: Are optimization recommendations supported by actual data? Brand Voice: Does the advertising sound and feel like the client? Accuracy: Are all factual claims supported? Business Outcome: Are we considering qualified leads and bookings when that information is available?

Core WIA Principle

Meta Ads should not simply amplify content. They should create a deliberate path from attention to action.

Reach, video views, engagement, clicks, CTR, CPL, and Meta's algorithmic recommendations all provide useful information, but none is the ultimate objective.

The objective is to use Meta strategically to put the right business in front of the right prospective customers, build enough relevance and familiarity to create demand, and ultimately turn that attention into qualified business opportunities.